

SOCIAL LIMITS

Move More. Scroll Less.

A Student Well-being
Partnership for Macquarie
University



MACQUARIE
University

Helping students
build healthier
digital habits from
the moment they
wake up.



[Home](#) [News](#) [Sport](#) [Business](#) [Technology](#) [Health](#) [Culture](#) [Arts](#) [Travel](#) [Earth](#) [Audio](#) [Video](#) [Live](#)

Meta and YouTube found liable in landmark social media addiction trial

1 day ago

Share  Save 

Kali Hays, Technology reporter, **Nardine Saad** and **Regan Morris**, Los Angeles

Screen time is reshaping student well-being

Screen-heavy mornings contribute to addictive scrolling, reduced movement, anxiety and academic disengagement.

6 hrs

average daily screen time for a university-age adult

That's 15 years over a lifetime

2×

higher anxiety & depression risk when using phone ≥4 hrs/day

Morning phone use is the primary trigger

20%

less daily movement in high-screen-time students

Cutting back 1 hr sees a 3× movement improvement

The research supports the approach

Peer-reviewed evidence underpins each of Social Limits' two core behavioural mechanisms.

01

Limiting social media reduces loneliness & depression

A randomised controlled trial found that restricting social media use to 30 minutes per day significantly reduced loneliness and depressive symptoms in university students after just three weeks.

Hunt et al., Journal of Social and Clinical Psychology, 2018

02

Physical activity significantly lowers depression risk

A systematic review found that individuals who engage in regular physical activity are significantly less likely to develop depression — with benefits observed even below the recommended 150 minutes per week.

Mammen & Faulkner, American Journal of Preventive Medicine, 2013

03

Social media scrolling increases anxiety in young people

Higher social media scrolling and posting among adolescents is associated with increased anxiety and behavioural problems — reinforcing the importance of early behavioural intervention.

Choi, Christiaans & Duerden, 2025

Social Limits blocks social media until students hit their step goal

One simple behaviour change that rewires the morning routine — replacing doom scrolling with movement.



Wake
Up

Social media is blocked every morning by default



Move

Students set their own daily step goal



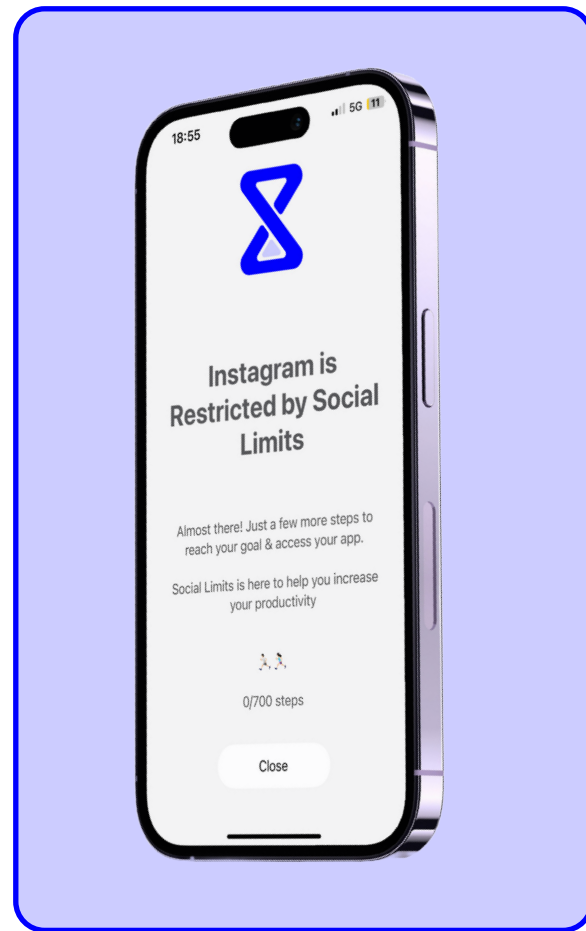
Unlock

Hit your goal social media is released



Nudge

Smart reminders if you go quiet



Rising demand. A window for early intervention.

Universities are responding reactively. Social Limits operates upstream before students reach the point of needing support.

The student well-being challenge

01

Sustained increase in demand

Counselling and mental health services at universities face year-on-year growth in demand, creating capacity pressure.

02

Anxiety & depression rising

Around 50% of young Australians aged 16–25 report high or very high psychological distress.

03

Digital habits as a driver

High social media engagement and disrupted daily routines are modifiable behavioural factors linked to youth mental distress.

04

The morning is the critical window

Screen-heavy mornings set the pattern for the rest of the day, anxiety, low movement, reduced focus.

Where Social Limits sits

CLINICAL SERVICES

Counselling, crisis support, psychiatric care



WELL-BEING PROGRAMS

Student sport, peer support, group wellness



SOCIAL LIMITS

Daily behavioural layer, movement before scrolling

A preventative behavioural tool — complementing existing services, not replacing them.

What this means for Macquarie

Measurable outcomes aligned directly with the Well-being & Belonging pillar and Retention taskforce priorities.

1

Retention Taskforce

Improved student retention

Students with stronger daily habits and lower distress are more likely to stay enrolled. Early behavioural intervention reduces the disengagement that precedes dropout.

2

Well-being Services

Reduced pressure on counselling

By supporting students before crisis point, Social Limits reduces upstream demand on well-being services.

3

Student Experience

Strengthens the student experience

A voluntary, student-led tool that adds genuine value to daily life, supporting Well-being & Belonging and showing investment in student health.

SOCIAL LIMITS

Let's explore how Social Limits can integrate into your student well-being program.

Move More. Scroll Less.

Option 1: 10k Licences + case study

Key Highlights

- 3 year contract + 1 year exist clause
- Implementation support to connect with SSO and enable students
- Predictable budget forecasting for a 3-year period and securing low pricing.
- Dashboard available for MQU to track adoption
- Option to increase licences at current price after 1 year

Year	Product	Quantity	Per Unit Price	Total Annual Investment
1	SL Licence	10,000	\$3.50	\$35,000
2	SL Licence	10,000	\$3.50	\$35,000
3	SL Licence	10,000	\$3.50	\$35,000

*All figures in AUD. Excluding GST

** All pricing is confidential for MQU

Option 2: Student wide coverage + case study

Key Highlights

- 3 year contract + 1 year exist clause
- Ease of licence deployment through university email login connected to MQU Active directory.
- Full Student Coverage.
- Predictable budget forecasting for a 3-year period and securing low pricing.
- Dashboard available for MQU to track adoption
- Student ambassadors x HOKA shoes

Year	Product	Quantity	Per Unit Price	Total Annual Investment
1	SL Licence	44,849	\$1.11	\$50,000
2	SL Licence	44,849	\$1.11	\$50,000
3	SL Licence	44,849	\$1.11	\$50,000

*All figures in AUD. Excluding GST

** All pricing is confidential for MQU

Option 3: Student wide coverage phased approach + case study

Key Highlights

- 1 year exit clause + progression based on 5% adoption after the first year
- Ease of licence deployment through university email login connected to MQU Active directory.
- Full Student Coverage.
- Predictable budget forecasting for a 3-year period and securing low pricing.
- Dashboard available for MQU to track adoption
- Student ambassadors x HOKA shoes

Year	Product	Quantity	Per Unit Price	Total Annual Investment
1	SL Licence	44,849	\$0.50	\$30,000
2	SL Licence	44,849	\$1.50	\$65,000
3	SL Licence	44,849	\$1.50	\$65,000

*All figures in AUD. Excluding GST

** All pricing is confidential for MQU

Improved student well-being across three dimensions



01

Enhanced Mental Health

- Reduces morning anxiety triggered by social media
- Builds digital discipline at the most critical time of day
- Supports mood stability through structured morning routines



02

Increased Physical Activity

- Proven to significantly increase daily step count
- Promotes movement as the gateway to app
- Reinforces sustainable physical habits over time



03

Academic Performance

- Reduces distraction-driven procrastination
- Students report improved focus and motivation
- Creates better conditions for morning study sessions